

Episode 167: Long Ago... 104 1995 Part 24 Finally "The Path to Power," However...

Well, *Mawaru Penguindrum* has finally begun broadcasting - have you all been watching? (grin)

Mawaru Penguindrum's production site has more female staff than any I've ever experienced. So I'm paying more attention than usual to my appearance and grooming. One aspect is my beard. I make sure to shave every day.

Speaking of shaving, as I wrote here before, the shaving cream problem. Recently, after using up what I'd been using, I went to buy new supplies and my eyes met something called "Shaving Gel." The colour and texture looked very refreshing, so I bought it for immediate trial.

Literally gel - putting bouncy gel in my palm and spreading it slickly on my face. Cool and refreshing up to this point. However, when I actually started shaving, huh? It doesn't shave as refreshingly as expected. Catching here and there, causing bloodshed (cry). Good grief. But I'll probably get used to it eventually...

Anyway.

There's been quite a gap, but the story returns to 1995.

The Great Hanshin-Awaji Earthquake, plus the subway sarin incident - I think it was a year with somehow restless, tense atmosphere.

Not that I was driven by such atmosphere, but work titles were extremely packed in 1995. Capping that year were naturally theatrical works. Theatrical *Dragon Ball: The Path to Power*. And double feature, theatrical *Neighbourhood Story*. These two became the final work of turbulent 1995 ~ early 1996.

As mentioned earlier, for theatrical *Neighbourhood Story* (Script: Kageyama Yumi, Animation Director: Umakoshi Yoshihiko, Art Director: Gyoshin Mitsu, Director: Shimizu Junji), I only did character colour design and special colouring design for several scenes - colour direction (色指定) work was handled by someone else.

Now, the problematic theatrical *Dragon Ball: The Path to Power*. Script: Matsui Aya, Character Design & Animation Director: Yamamuro Tadayoshi, Art Directors: Tsuji Tadanao & Higashi Jun'ichi, Director: Yamauchi Shigeyasu. Incidentally, assistant directors were Sakai Munehisa and Nagamine Tatsuya - the young days of new and old *PreCure* series directors for *Suite PreCure♪* and *Heartcatch PreCure!* (laugh).

When my participation was officially decided at summer's end, storyboard work wasn't even half finished, with just occasional promotional stills coming around. I myself was extremely busy with TV *Neighbourhood Story*, theatrical *Sailor Moon SS*, plus *Dragon Quest VI* work, so I was half-neglecting *The Path to Power* work. Somehow, having completely figured out Toei's theatrical work schedules over recent years, I felt "well, still far off~."

However, unbeknownst to me, *The Path to Power* had fallen into various problematic situations. Not simply storyboard delays, but apparently fundamental content issues. And then...

"We're having an overall review meeting for *The Path to Power!*"

Producer Morishita-san issued the order. All main staff, production people, and planning people were summoned to a large room at Hotel Hikarigaoka near Oizumi Studio. October 19th evening.

(11.07.12)